

How to Explain This BRD

A simple walkthrough & talking points · Spotify India engagement & listening time

Use this to **present** the BRD with confidence. It gives you the pitch, the story, one-line talking points for each section, the ‘fancy words’ in plain English, and answers to the questions people usually ask.

The 30-second pitch (say this first)

“India is a massive audience but low on revenue. The best lever we have is listening time — the more people listen, the more they stay, and the more they stay, the more we earn. This document defines that problem clearly, so we all agree on what to solve and why — before we design anything.”

The story in four beats

People remember stories, not sections. Walk them through this arc:

- **1. Why India matters:** huge, young, fast-growing audience — but among our lowest revenue per user. Big opportunity, real pressure.
- **2. The problem:** people aren't listening enough or building the daily habit — often because of relevance, data/device cost, or 'good-enough' free rivals.
- **3. Why it matters to the business:** listening time → retention → revenue. It's a chain, and listening time is the first link.
- **4. What this document does:** it defines the problem so everyone aligns — it deliberately does *not* jump to solutions.

One-line talking points, section by section

BRD section (as in the brief)	Say this in one line	Why it's there
Executive Summary Snapshot	“The problem and why it matters, in a paragraph.”	Sets the frame fast.
Project Description	“What this is, and the goal we're after.”	Business + product goal.
Project Scope (In/Out)	“We're defining the problem, not the fix.”	Prevents scope creep.
Business Drivers	“These forces make it urgent now.”	Answers ‘why now.’
Current Process	“How people listen today — and where we lose them.”	Grounded (personas + journey).
Proposed Process	“Reframed as four problems: relevance, access, habit, value.”	Framing, not solutions.
Functional / Non-Functional Requirements	“The needs any solution must meet — no features yet.”	Problem-focused.
Success Criteria & KPIs	“North Star is listening time; here's how it maps to money.”	How we'll know it worked.

BRD section (as in the brief)	Say this in one line	Why it's there
Assumptions and Constraints	"What we're assuming and what's fixed."	Honest about limits.
Stakeholders	"Who owns and informs each part."	Clear roles.

The 'fancy words,' in plain English

If someone looks puzzled, here's how to explain each term simply:

Term	How to explain it
Business vs product outcomes	"The goal (money, retention) vs the thing we can actually move (listening time)."
North Star metric	"The one number that best shows we're delivering value — here, time spent listening."
KPI tree	"A simple map: listening time at the top, rolling up into retention, then revenue."
Job-to-be-Done (JTBD)	"The real reason someone plays music — e.g. 'something effortless for my commute.'"
Persona / journey map	"A stand-in user and their path, so we design for real people, not averages."
Functional vs non-functional	"What it must do vs how well it must do it (fast, light on data, reliable)."
Hypothesis	"A smart guess we'll test next — not a conclusion."

If someone asks... (quick answers)

You might hear...	You can say...
"Why not just build features?"	"Because we haven't agreed on the problem yet. Solving the wrong problem quickly is expensive — this aligns us first."
"Where's the hard data?"	"Market context is cited; the specific baselines come from our Milestone 1 research — marked [M1] to slot in."
"Why listening time, not installs?"	"Installs are vanity; listening time is the value people actually get, and it predicts retention and revenue."
"Is this just about premium users?"	"No — free users matter too. Their listening drives ad revenue and future conversion."
"What happens after this?"	"Milestone 3: we test the assumptions; then a PRD and design. Solutions start there."
"Isn't engagement too vague?"	"That's why we anchor it to one clear number — time spent listening — and a KPI tree tying it to the business."

Presenting tips

Do:

- Start with the business **why**, then the problem.
- Use a persona (like Aditya or Meera) to make it real — people connect with a person, not a metric.

- Keep pulling the conversation back to the **problem**, not the fix.
- Point to the KPI tree when someone worries 'engagement' is fuzzy.

Don't:

- Jump to features or solutions — that's a later milestone.
- Drown people in metrics — lead with the one North Star.
- Over-claim numbers you can't cite — use the **[M1]** placeholders honestly.

Leave them with this

"If we get people to listen just a little more — by making it more relevant, easier to access, and worth the habit — retention, ads, and subscriptions all follow. That's the whole game. Today, we're just agreeing on the problem."